Tatas. It was awarded major contracts of Tata Power and other companies. In addition, the Shapoorji Pallonji Group also had several lucrative agencies from the Tata Group. They even had the right of first refusal when Tata exited from companies; thus they managed to purchase entities such as Forbes and Co. Pallonji had also maintained a close relationship with Naval Tata and the two had become business partners. The relationship between the Mistrys and Tatas went beyond business when Pallonji's daughter Aloo married Noel Tata.

The question is whether, after about two decades of the Pallonji Group increasing their share in Tata Sons, Cyrus Mistry sensed an opportunity to make further inroads into the group. Did he start ignoring the Tata Trusts as part of this larger plan? Did Ratan see it in this manner? Was it an effort, as some saw, to dismantle the legacy of Ratan and of the Tatas altogether?

Many, especially Tata veterans, are inclined to believe that the replies to the above questions could only be in the affirmative. The major reason for them to take this position was that before becoming chairman, Mistry had advocated the creation of a framework for the running of Tata Sons and its companies, but soon after adorning the mantle he took a contrarian position. As chairman, he chose not to implement what he said a chairman of Tata Sons should do.

Mistry's first about-face was in the role that he had recommended that the Tata Trusts play in the affairs of Tata Sons. Mistry had strongly advocated an important role for the Trusts in the affairs of the holding company and its promoted entities.

He had made two recommendations regarding this issue. The first was that the Tata Trusts should be continuously involved in developing group strategies of Tata Sons. The second was the role he advocated for Tata Trusts to play in the matters of various companies. He sought the Trusts' specific participation in dealing with the 'government in India' and 'internationally'.

But soon after he took over, he alleged that the Tata Trusts interfered with the affairs of Tata Sons. For argument's sake, even if this were true, it would not have been an unconceivable situation.

Tata Trusts and Tata Sons also have a sort of employer–employee relationship. The Sir Ratan Tata was created in 1919. In 1932, Dorabji Tata created two trusts, and all their interests in the firm, Tata Sons Ltd, were transferred to these trusts.